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INTRODUCTION

The first two tasks, the **Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic** and **Student Digital Portfolio**, focus on establishing a visible online identity. By creating visual resources and setting up platforms like LinkedIn and GitHub, the goal is to bridge the gap between basic internet usage and a professional online presence.

The third and fourth tasks, **Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms** and **Draft a Professional Email & Etiquette Guide**, emphasize practical communication and technical teamwork. These modules ensure mastery over essential tools for modern workflows while refining the "soft skills" required for high-stakes professional environments.

Finally, the **Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide** addresses the critical need for security. By analyzing real-world threats, this task provides the defensive knowledge necessary to navigate the digital landscape safely. Together, these five tasks transform a student from a passive digital consumer into an informed, professional, and secure digital citizen.

TASK1 - Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

- **Tools used**

I created a one-page infographic for this assignment using Canva with the goal of encouraging students' digital literacy. I was able to arrange complicated information into a neat, polished format appropriate for a campus-wide resource thanks to the tool's layout flexibility.

- **Design**

The design is made around three main points: outlining safe internet practices, defining what digital literacy actually means in a contemporary setting, and identifying crucial digital tools for academic success. In particular, the graphic provides a clear explanation of how to confirm information found online and emphasizes the value of keeping a professional online presence on sites like LinkedIn. To make the information easy to scan and remember, it employs a consistent color scheme and iconography.

- **Interesting point**

The most interesting part of this process was the challenge of information hierarchy. As a student often focused on technical implementation, it was a unique exercise to strip away jargon and determine which three points were the most critical for a general audience. Finding the balance between "too much text" and "not enough detail" required several iterations, but it ultimately made the final resource much more effective for peer-to-peer education.

TASK2 - Student Digital Portfolio

- **Platforms chosen**

To establish a foundational professional presence, I selected GitHub, Stack Overflow, and LinkedIn as my primary digital platforms. Each serves a distinct purpose in my development as a B.Tech student and future engineer.

- **Uses**

GitHub acts as my technical repository, where I host source code and collaborate on version-controlled projects, showcasing my practical coding abilities. Stack Overflow is my dedicated platform for technical problem-solving and community engagement; it allows me to contribute to developer discussions and document my journey in debugging complex issues. Lastly, LinkedIn serves as my professional networking hub, connecting me with industry experts and documenting my academic milestones and certifications.

- **Future Planning**

Over the next four years, I plan to integrate these tools into my daily workflow. I will use GitHub to maintain a consistent contribution streak for my MERN stack projects. On Stack Overflow, I aim to move from a passive learner to an active contributor by answering technical queries once I master specific frameworks. Finally, I will leverage LinkedIn to build a professional brand, sharing project updates and securing internship opportunities. Maintaining these profiles ensures my digital footprint reflects technical competency and professional readiness.

TASK3 - Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms

- **Platform used**

For the third module of this project, I utilized HackerRank for coding practice and Google Workspace for cloud collaboration. These platforms were chosen to demonstrate a balance between individual technical proficiency and the ability to gather and manage data within a team or community context.

- **What I practiced**

On HackerRank, I completed the introductory "Solve Me First" challenge. This exercise involved implementing a basic function to sum two integers, which served as a refresher on platform-specific input/output handling and competitive programming syntax. For the collaboration component, I built a "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" using Google Forms. This quiz consists of five targeted questions designed to gauge my peers' understanding of online safety and digital ethics. I also

linked the form to a Google Sheet to ensure real-time response tracking and data organization.

- **Academic use**

Academically, these tools are indispensable. HackerRank helps me refine the logical problem-solving skills required for my technical coursework and future coding interviews. Meanwhile, Google Workspace streamlines academic collaboration, allowing me to manage group projects and research data efficiently. Together, these platforms enhance my ability to function as an effective, data-driven Digital Ambassador within the campus ecosystem.

TASK4 - Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

- **Situation where poor digital communication caused a real problem**

A significant real-world problem caused by poor digital communication often occurs during high-stakes internship applications. In a common hypothetical scenario, a student might send a mass email to multiple recruiters using "BCC" but forgets to personalize the salutation or, worse, attaches a file named "Resume_Draft_Final_2.pdf."

- **what could have been done differently**

This lack of professional etiquette often leads to immediate rejection, as it signals a lack of attention to detail and disrespect for the recruiter's time. To prevent this, the student should have used a clear, specific subject line including their name and the role applied for. Furthermore, they should have addressed the coordinator by name and ensured all attachments were professionally titled (e.g., "XYZ_Resume.pdf"). Adhering to these simple digital etiquette rules transforms a generic, ignored message into a credible professional inquiry, demonstrating readiness for a corporate environment.

TASK5 - Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

- **Surprising points**

Researching Ransomware for this case study revealed how sophisticated modern "Ransomware-as-a-Service" (RaaS) models have become. What surprised me most was the realization that individuals are often targeted not just for their data, but as entry points into larger institutional networks. I was particularly struck by the "Double Extortion" tactic, where hackers not only encrypt files but also threaten to leak

sensitive personal data publicly if the ransom isn't paid, making the consequences far more permanent than a simple loss of access.

- **one habit I will personally change**

As a result of this research, the one habit I will personally change is my approach to data backups and software hygiene. I plan to implement an automated "3-2-1" backup strategy, ensuring I have at least one offline copy of my critical coding projects and documents. Additionally, I will stop delaying "Critical Security Updates" on my OS and applications, as these patches often close the very vulnerabilities ransomware exploits to gain a foothold.

CONCLUSION

Through these five tasks, I have successfully transitioned from a student to an informed Student Digital Ambassador. By creating a Digital Literacy Infographic and building a professional portfolio on GitHub, Stack Overflow, and LinkedIn, I established a credible online identity. Mastering HackerRank and Google Workspace enhanced my technical and collaborative skills, while drafting professional emails refined my corporate communication. Finally, analyzing Ransomware deepened my security awareness. This project has equipped me with the essential digital fluency and professional etiquette required to navigate my B.Tech journey at VIT Bhopal with technical competence and safety.

REFERENCES

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